

TOPIC 4: CONTINUOUS WRITING : DEBATE

A debate is an argument between two persons or group of persons over an issue or a topic. It is an argumentative essay where the writer is expected to argue logically in support or against a topic.

It aims at convincing the audience or the reader to share the opinion or view points of the writer.

A debate could be written or delivered orally.

FEATURES/FORMAT OF A DEBATE

1. The Topic: The topic should be clearly stated and should be underlined if written in small letters
2. The Vocatives: This is the greetings to acknowledge the presence of the members of the panel and the audience. Examples:

The Moderator/Chairman, Panel of Judges, Accurate Time Keeper, Co-Debaters, Fellow Students/The audience

3. The Introduction: The speaker/writer is expected to introduce himself (if it is oral debate) .State the topic and take a stand whether in support or against the motion. The key words in the topic could be defined, quoting from a reliable source.
4. The Body: The speaker/writer should state at least three strong points in favour of his stand to persuade the judges and win them to his side. Also a paragraph should have one point well explained. It is good to counter the opinion of the opponent with good reasons.
5. The Conclusion: Summarize the points raised to re-affirm your position earlier taken by stating that your view points are better than your opponent.

CLASS ACTIVITY

You are the Chief speaker representing your school on a debate topic. Technology has done more harm than good. Write in support or against the topic. This should be not less than 450 words.